

Case Definitions for Priority diseases, conditions, and events for Integrated Disease Surveillance and Response

Epidemic prone diseases or immediately notifiable conditions

Acute Haemorrhagic Fever Syndrome

Acute onset of fever of less than 3 weeks duration in a severely ill patient **AND** any 2 of the following: haemorrhagic or purpuric rash; epistaxis (nosebleed); haematemesis (blood in vomit); hemoptysis (blood in sputum); blood in stool; other haemorrhagic symptoms and no known predisposing factors for haemorrhagic manifestations; **OR** human suspicion of any of the viral diseases.

Human Anthrax

Any person with illness of acute onset characterized by several clinical forms which are:

- Cutaneous:** Any person with skin lesion evolving over 1 to 6 days from a papular through a vesicular stage, to a depressed black eschar invariably accompanied by edemthat may be mild to extensive.
 - Gastro-intestinal:** Any person with abdominal distress characterized by nausea, vomiting, Anorexia and followed by fever.
 - Pulmonary (inhalation):** Any person with brief prodrome resembling acute viral respiratory illness, followed by rapid onset of hypoxia, dyspnoea, and high temperature, with the X-ray evidence of mediastinal widening.
 - Meningeal:** Any person with acute onset of high fever possibly with convulsions, loss of consciousness, meningeal signs and symptoms; commonly noted in all systemic infections but may present without any other clinical symptoms of anthrax.
- AND** has an epidemiological link to confirmed or suspected animal cases or contaminated animal products.

Cholera

Severe dehydration or death from acute watery diarrhea in a patient aged 2 years or more (in the absence of an epidemic) **OR**:

Acute watery diarrhea in any person or patient (during an epidemic)

Meningococcal meningitis

Any person with sudden onset of fever ($\geq 38.5^{\circ}\text{C}$ (rectal) or 38°C (axillary), headache and one of the following signs; neck stiffness, altered consciousness or other meningeal signs.

Diarrhea with blood (Shigella)

A person with (abdominal pain) and diarrhea with visible blood in stool

Measles

Any person with fever ($>38.5^{\circ}\text{C}$) and maculopapular (non-vesicular) generalized rash and at least one of the following cough, coryza, or conjunctivitis (red eyes)

OR Any person in whom a clinician suspects measles.

Diphtheria

An illness of the upper respiratory tract characterized by laryngitis or tonsillitis, **AND** adherent membranes of tonsils, pharynx and/or nose.

Pertussis (Whooping Cough)

A person with cough lasting at least two weeks and at least one of the following: paroxysms (i.e. fits) of coughing; inspiratory whooping; post-tussive vomiting (vomiting immediately after coughing) without any other apparent cause **OR** a case diagnosed as pertussis by a Clinician.

Plague

Any person with sudden onset of fever, chills, headache, severe malaise, prostration, and very painful swelling of lymph nodes, **OR** cough with blood-stained sputum, chest pain, and difficulty in breathing

Influenza-like illness (ILI)

A person with an acute respiratory illness with sudden onset of fever ($\geq 38^{\circ}\text{C}$) **AND** Cough

Severe Acute Respiratory Infection (SARI)

A person ($>5\text{yrs}$) with an acute respiratory illness with fever and cough and requiring hospital admission **OR** a child (2-5yrs) with fast breathing and cough or difficulty **OR** any death from an unexplained respiratory illness.

Typhoid Fever

Any person with gradual onset of steadily increasing and then persistently high fever, chills, malaise, headache, sore throat, cough, and sometimes, abdominal pain and constipation or diarrhea.

Yellow Fever

Any person with acute onset of fever, with jaundice appearing within 14 days of onset of the first symptoms.

Malaria

Uncomplicated malaria: Any person with fever or history of fever within 24 hours; without signs of severe disease (vital organ dysfunction) is diagnosed clinically as malaria.

Confirmed uncomplicated malaria: Any person with fever or history of fever within 24 hours; and with laboratory confirmation of diagnosis by malaria blood film or other diagnostic test for malaria parasites.

Unconfirmed severe malaria: Any patient hospitalized with severe febrile disease with accompanying vital organ dysfunction diagnosed clinically.

Confirmed severe malaria: Any patient hospitalized with P. Falciparum asexual parasitemia as confirmed by laboratory tests with accompanying symptoms and signs of severe disease (vital organ dysfunction) diagnosed through laboratory.

Human Rabies

A person with one or more of the following: headache, neck pain, nausea, fever, fear of water, anxiety, agitation, abnormal tingling sensations or pain at the wound site, when contact with a rabid animal is suspected.

Acute viral hepatitis

Any person with acute illness typically: acute jaundice (1 month), dark urine, anorexia, malaise, extreme fatigue, and right upper quadrant tenderness. (Note: infected children are often asymptomatic)

Outbreak of unknown cause (Mysterious illness)

Any cluster of two or more cases/deaths presenting with similar symptoms with negative laboratory tests for common local diseases and which fail to respond to treatment for the usual cause of the symptoms and occurring in a given place and during a short time period.

Maternal deaths

The death of a woman while pregnant or within 42 days of the delivery or termination of the pregnancy, irrespective of the duration and site of the pregnancy, from any cause related to or aggravated by the pregnancy or its management but not from accidental or incidental causes.

Perinatal deaths

Death of a baby around the time of birth, including either a still birth or death of a newborn during the first week of life

Mpox

Suspected case: An acute illness with fever ($\geq 38.5^{\circ}\text{C}$), intense headache, lymphadenopathy, back pain, myalgia, and intense asthenia followed one to three days later by a progressively developing rash often beginning on the face (most dense) and then spreading elsewhere on the body, including soles of feet and palms of hands.

Probable case: A case that meets the clinical case definition, is not laboratory confirmed, but has an epidemiological link to a confirmed or probable case
Confirmed case: A clinically compatible case that is laboratory confirmed.
Differential diagnosis: Alternative causes of clinical symptoms that must be considered include other rash illnesses, such as smallpox, chickenpox, measles, bacterial skin infections, scabies, syphilis, and medication-associated allergies.

Diseases targeted for eradication or elimination

Dracunculiasis

A person presenting with a skin lesion with itching or blister living in an endemic area of Guinea worm.

Leprosy

A person showing one of three cardinal signs of leprosy: hypo-pigmented or reddish skin lesion, loss or decrease of sensations in skin patch or enlargement of peripheral nerve.

Neonatal tetanus

Any newborn with normal ability to suck and cry during the first 2 days of life and who, between the 3rd and 28th day of age, cannot suck normally and becomes stiff or has spasms (i.e. jerking of the muscles on external stimuli) or both.

Polio myelitis (AFP)

Any child under 15 years of age with acute flaccid paralysis of one or more limbs or any person with paralytic illness at any age in whom the clinician suspects poliomyelitis.

Onchocerciasis

In an endemic area, any person with fibrous nodules in subcutaneous tissues.

Buruli ulcer

A person presenting with a painless skin nodule, plaque or ulcer, living or having visited a Buruli Ulcer endemic area.

Lymphatic Filariasis

Hydrocoele or lymphoedema in a resident of an endemic area for which other causes of these findings have been excluded.

Noma

Any child with a mouth ulcer and other warning signs such as; malnutrition, poor hygiene, recent illness from; measles, persistent diarrhea, or malaria.

Diseases or events of international concern (In addition to those noted in other columns)

Human influenza due to a new subtype

Suspected H5N1 case: Any person presenting with unexplained acute lower respiratory illness with fever ($>38^{\circ}\text{C}$) and cough, shortness of breath or difficulty breathing **AND** one or more of the following exposures within the 7 days prior to symptom onset:

- Close contact (within 1 meter) with a person (e.g. caring for, speaking with, or touching) who is a suspected, probable, or confirmed H5N1 case;
- Exposure (e.g. handling, slaughtering, de-feathering, butchering, preparation for consumption) to poultry or wild birds or their remains or to environments contaminated by their faeces in an area where H5N1 infections in animals or humans have been suspected or confirmed in the last month;
- Consumption of raw or undercooked poultry products in an area where H5N1 infections in animals or humans have been suspected or confirmed in the last month;
- Close contact with a confirmed H5N1 infected animal other than poultry or wild birds;
- Handling samples (animal or human) suspected of containing H5N1 virus in a laboratory or other setting.

Suspected pandemic (H1N1) 2009 virus infection: An individual presenting with influenza-like-illness (sudden onset of fever $>38^{\circ}\text{C}$ and cough or sore throat in the absence of another diagnosis) with a history of exposure to a case of pandemic (H1N1) 2009 virus.

Severe Acute Respiratory Syndrome (SARS)

An individual with:

- A history of fever, or documented fever $\geq 38^{\circ}\text{C}$ **AND**
- One or more symptoms of lower respiratory tract illness (cough, difficulty breathing, and shortness of breath) **AND**
- Radiographic evidence of lung infiltrates consistent with pneumonia or ARDS or autopsy findings consistent with pneumonia or ARDS without an identifiable cause **AND**
- No alternative diagnosis can fully explain the illness.

COVID-19

A person with acute onset of fever **AND** cough; **OR** acute onset of ANY THREE **OR** MORE of the following signs or symptoms: fever, cough, general weakness/fatigue, headache, myalgia, sore throat, coryza, dyspnoea, anorexia/nausea/vomiting, diarrhoea, altered mental status **OR** A patient with severe acute respiratory illness (SARI: acute respiratory infection with history of fever or measured fever of $\geq 38^{\circ}\text{C}$; and cough; with onset within the last 14 days; and who requires hospitalization.

Smallpox

An illness with acute onset of fever $>38.3^{\circ}\text{C}$ followed by a rash characterized by vesicles or firm pustules in the same stage of development without other apparent cause.

Chemical events

An uncontrolled release (accidental spill or deliberate) of a chemical from its containment (e.g. factory) that either threatens to, or does, expose people to a chemical hazard.

Radiological events

An uncontrolled release (accidental spill or deliberate) of a radioactive substance from its containment (e.g. nuclear power plant, industrial plant) that either threatens to, or does, expose people to nuclear or radiological hazards including burns, radiation sickness, death or cancers.

Foodborne illness

Two or more people present with similar symptoms and who consumed common food or drink.

Botulism (foodborne): An illness characterized by diplopia (double vision), blurred vision, and bulbar weakness (bulbar are muscles of the jaw, face, palate, pharynx, larynx, tongue) and symmetric descending paralysis that may progress rapidly.

Methanol poisoning: Any person who develops vomiting, lethargy, visual impairment and coma following the ingestion of methanol or adulterated alcohol.

Other major diseases of public health importance

Diarrhea with dehydration $<5\text{yrs}$

Any child who passes 3 or more loose or watery stools in 24 hours, lasting less than 14 days and, some dehydration (two or more of the following: restlessness, irritability; sunken eyes; thirsty; skin pinch goes back slowly), or severe dehydration (two or more of the following: lethargy or unconsciousness; sunken eyes , not able or drinking poorly; skin pinch goes back very slowly) in the absence of a cholera epidemic.

Severe pneumonia $<5\text{yrs}$

A child with cough or difficult breathing and fast breathing (50 or more breaths per minute for infant age 2 months up to 1 year; or 40 or more breaths per minute for child 1 year up to 5 years).

New HIV/AIDS

A positive ELISA for confirming HIV and a rapid test for confirming the positive results are sufficient for an epidemiologic case definition for HIV Infection.

Pulmonary Tuberculosis (PTB)

A person with a cough for three weeks or more.

Multi-drug resistant TB (MDR-TB)

Any patient who has confirmed drug resistance to Rifampicin and Isoniazid

Extensively Drug Resistant TB (XDR-TB)

Any patient with resistance to Rifampicin and Isoniazid and who is found to be resistant to one fluoroquinolone and one aminoglycoside such as Kanamycin that is used to treat drug resistant TB.

Sexually Transmitted Infections (STIs)

Genital ulcer syndrome (non-vesicular): Any male with an ulcer on the penis, scrotum, or rectum, with or without inguinal adenopathy, or any female with ulcer on labia, vagina, or rectum, with or without inguinal adenopathy
Urethral discharge syndrome: Any male with urethral discharge with or without dysuria.

Abnormal vaginal discharge: Abnormal increase of vaginal discharge with or without lower abdominal pain (normal discharge is small in quantity and white to colorless).

Sexually transmitted infection due to SGBV: Any woman who contracts an infection after being forced against her will into sexual intercourse with a man.
Trypanosomiasis

Early stage: Any one with a persistent fever, with intense headache, insomnia, painless lymphadenopathy, anemia, local edema and rash. A painful chancre originating as a papule and then evolving into a nodule at the primary flybite site may be seen. Late stage: cachexia, somnolence, and central nervous system signs.

Trachoma

Any patient with red sticky eyes who complains of pain and itchiness of the eyes.

Visceral Leishmaniasis (Kalaazar)

An illness with prolonged irregular fever, splenomegaly and weight loss as its main symptoms from a known endemic area.

Brucellosis (Human)

Acute or insidious onset of fever and one or more of the following: night sweats, arthralgia, headache, fatigue, anorexia, myalgia, weight loss, arthritis/spondylitis, meningitis, or focal organ involvement (endocarditis, orchitis/epididymitis, hepatomegaly, splenomegaly).

Schistosomiasis

A person with visible haematuria with positive reagent strip for hematuria or eggs of S. haematobium in urine **OR** chronic or recurrent blood in stool, bloody diarrhea, diarrhea, abdominal pains, or, at a later stage, hepatosplenomegaly with eggs of S. mansoni, or S. japonicum in stools.

Hypertension

Any individual presenting on at least two occasions with a resting blood pressure measurement (based on the average of 3 readings) at or above 140 mm Hg for systolic pressure, or greater than or equal to 90 mm Hg for diastolic pressure (Report only newly diagnosed cases).

Diabetes mellitus (DM)

Any person presenting with increased thirst, increased hunger, and frequent urination with; a fasting venous plasma glucose measurement of $\geq 7\text{mmol/L}$ (126 mg/dl) or capillary glucose $\geq 6.1\text{mmol/L}$ (110 mg/dl) **OR** A non-fasting venous plasma glucose measurement of $\geq 11.1\text{mmol/L}$ (200 mg/dl) or capillary glucose $\geq 11.1\text{mmol/L}$ (200 mg/dl) (report only newly diagnosed cases).

Nodding Syndrome

Any person (usually child or adolescent) who was normal prior to being reported with head nodding that manifests with repetitive involuntary drops of the head towards the chest on two or more occasions (report only newly diagnosed cases).

Adverse events following immunization (AEFI)

These are medical incidents or reactions observed within four weeks following immunization and are believed to be caused by vaccination.

Adverse Drug Reaction (ADR)

Is response to a medicine which is noxious and unintended, and which occurs at doses normally used in man for the prophylaxis, diagnosis or treatment of a disease or for the modification of physiological function.

Injuries

Road traffic accidents: Any person who sustains injuries or dies immediately or within 30 days as a result of road traffic crash presenting for the first time.

Due to gender based violence: Any woman who sustains physical injuries due to violence effected by a man directed specifically against the woman and which is derived from unequal power relationships between men and women.

Trauma due to other causes: Any person who sustains physical injuries from causes other than road traffic accidents or gender-based violence.



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